

The free guide

The Book-to-Skill Setup Guide

Put any book you own on Claude's bookshelf as a skill. The two-minute install, the exact folder it builds, the five books to convert first, and the workaround for books you don't own.

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Install the converter in two minutes

Book-to-skill is a free, open source skill. You point it at a PDF and it reads the book chapter by chapter, pulls out the frameworks, the decision rules and the mistakes the author tells you not to make, and writes all of that into a skill Claude can pull off the shelf whenever the job calls for it.

The fastest install is to paste this into Claude Code and let it do the work:

TEXT

Install the book-to-skill skill from
https://github.com/virgiliojr94/book-to-skill
into my personal skills folder at ~/.claude/skills/
so it works in every project.

If you'd rather run it yourself, one command does the same thing:

BASH

npx skills add virgiliojr94/book-to-skill

Book-to-skill on GitHub

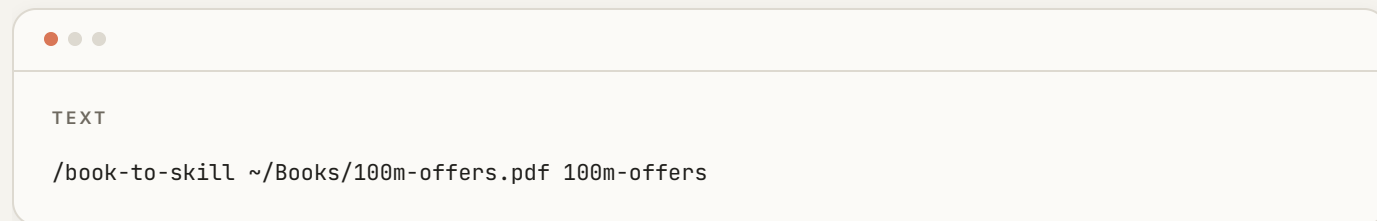
SKILLS FOLDER	WHAT IT MEANS
~/.claude/skills/	Personal. The skill works in every project on your machine
.claude/skills/ inside a project	Project only. Good for a business repo where the book skills belong to that business

Quick check: open a fresh Claude Code session and type `/book`. If book-to-skill shows up in the autocomplete, you're installed. That's the whole setup.

Convert your first book

Only convert books and documents
you own a copy of.

Open Claude Code, type the slash command, and point it at the file. The last word is the name the skill gets:

A screenshot of a terminal window with a light gray background. At the top, there are three small circles (red, yellow, green) representing window controls. Below them, the word "TEXT" is displayed in a small, gray, monospace font. The main content of the terminal is a single line of text in a monospace font: `/book-to-skill ~/Books/100m-offers.pdf 100m-offers`.

```
TEXT  
  
/book-to-skill ~/Books/100m-offers.pdf 100m-offers
```

The first thing it asks is whether the book is technical or text-heavy. Business books are text-heavy, so pick that and it pulls the words out in about a second. Then it reads the structure, finds the chapters on its own, and starts writing, one chapter at a time. A 200 page book takes a few minutes. When it's done, this is what's sitting in your skills folder:

FILE	WHAT'S IN IT	WHEN CLAUDE READS IT
SKILL.md	The core ideas, a workflow for using the book, and an index of every chapter	The name and description load every session. The rest loads when the job matches
chapters/	One file per chapter: the frameworks, rules and examples from that chapter	When it needs the exact wording or a worked example
glossary.md	The author's own terms, defined the way the author defines them	When you use the author's language in a prompt
patterns.md	Every named technique in the book, in one place	When it's applying a technique to your work
cheatsheet.md	The decision rules, compressed	When it needs to make a call fast

This layout is the reason it works so well. The only part Claude loads at the start of a session is the front of the skill, the name and a line about when to use it. Everything else stays on the shelf until you ask for a headline or a proposal, and then it goes and reads the right chapter properly. Which is exactly how you'd use the book yourself. You don't reread the whole thing every time you write an ad, you flip to the page you need.

Three things that catch people out:

- 1. Scanned PDFs have no text to extract.** If the book was photographed or scanned, the converter stops on page one and tells you. Run it through OCR first (on a Mac, Preview and the built-in Vision OCR both work; any OCR tool does) and feed it the text file instead. My copy of The Challenger Sale was a scan, and this is how it got done.
- 2. A folder of PDFs becomes one skill.** Point the command at the folder and it builds one skill with a chapter per document and a routing table in the SKILL.md. That's how the ten \$100M Playbooks became one skill Claude can route to.
- 3. Test it with three real prompts before you trust it.** Ask for something the book is meant to do, something adjacent, and something unrelated. It should pull the skill for the first two and leave it alone for the third. If it doesn't, the fix is in the next section.

Make the skill do a job, not a book report

Here's the part that matters most. Claude has technically read all of these books already. Ask it about Breakthrough Advertising and it'll name the frameworks straight back at you. But when you ask it to write a landing page using them, you get the same AI-sounding copy as everyone else, because the model forgets the specifics and defaults to the most probable output. A summary doesn't fix that. What fixes it is forcing the model to run the actual techniques, with the actual worked examples and decision rules in front of it.

So the test for a good book skill isn't "does it describe the book". It's "can Claude run the book on my work". Two edits get you there.

1. Write the description as the phrases you'd actually type. The description line is the only thing Claude sees before it decides whether to pull the skill off the shelf. A description that says "knowledge from \$100M Offers" gets ignored. One that lists the jobs gets used. This is the shape mine take:

TEXT

```
description: The working method from "$100M Offers" by Alex Hormozi.  
Main job: take a rough offer idea and build a Grand Slam Offer end  
to end (value equation scoring, trim and stack, scarcity, urgency,  
bonuses, a written guarantee, a name). Use whenever someone says:  
build my offer, package this service, what should I charge, my  
offer isn't converting, write me a guarantee, add bonuses, or asks  
about the value equation or trim and stack. Use it even when the  
book is not named.
```

2. Give the SKILL.md a workflow with modes. The best book skills on my shelf have two modes, one for before and one for after. The Challenger Sale skill has a Prep mode that builds a call sheet from the prospect's details, and a Grade mode that takes the call recording back in and scores me against the six steps, including how early I started pitching. That turns a sales book into a loop I improve inside every week. Ask Claude to add this when the conversion finishes:



TEXT

Add a Workflow section at the top of SKILL.md with two modes.

PREP: before the work, take my inputs and produce a one-page plan using the book's framework, citing the chapter each step comes from.

GRADE: after the work, take my transcript or draft and score it step by step against the same framework, naming what I skipped.

Keep every step traceable to a chapter file.

The rule: a book skill earns its place on the shelf when it has a job, a trigger, and a chapter to point at for every step. Anything less is a book report, and Claude already has plenty of those.

The five books to convert first

These are the five I gave Claude first, each one picked for a specific problem I kept running into using Claude as a founder. Convert them in this order if you own them.

#	BOOK	THE PROBLEM IT FIXES	SAY THIS TO CLAUDE
1	Breakthrough Advertising, Eugene Schwartz	Landing page and ad copy that sounds like every other AI page	"Diagnose who's reading this page and rewrite it using Breakthrough Advertising"
2	\$100M Offers, Alex Hormozi (plus the ten \$100M Playbooks)	Weak offers, vague guarantees, price comparisons	"Build this into a Grand Slam Offer"
3	The Challenger Sale, Dixon and Adamson	Calls where you pitch too early and teach nothing	"Prep me for this call" and "grade this call"
4	Pricing Creativity, Blair Enns	Claude inventing prices out of thin air	"Price this project from the call transcript"
5	Decisive, Chip and Dan Heath	Claude agreeing with whatever you already lean towards	"I'm stuck on a decision, run me through it"

When you don't own the book

I don't own a copy of Decisive. The skill above was built without it, and the same method works for any framework book. Every well known business book has hundreds of summaries published online, and enough of them stitched together gets you most of the way to the book itself.

Step 1. Have Claude collect the summaries. Ask for the long ones that walk the book chapter by chapter, not the two-paragraph blurbs:

TEXT

Find five or six long, written, chapter-by-chapter summaries of "Decisive" by Chip and Dan Heath. Prefer summaries that name the frameworks and give the book's own examples. Save each one as a markdown file in ~/Books/decisive-sources/ with the source URL at the top. Skip anything under 1,000 words.

Step 2. Add three summary videos with the watch skill. Written summaries miss the examples people remember out loud. The watch skill gives Claude the transcript and the frames of any YouTube video, so the summary videos become sources too:

TEXT

Use the watch skill on these three videos and save each transcript to ~/Books/decisive-sources/ as its own file, source URL at the top:

```
<url 1>
<url 2>
<url 3>
```

[Watch skill on GitHub \(free\)](#)

Step 3. Convert the folder like it's the book. Point book-to-skill at the sources folder and it builds the same shape: SKILL.md, chapters, glossary, patterns and cheat sheet.

TEXT

/book-to-skill ~/Books/decisive-sources/ decisive

Step 4. Be honest inside the skill. Ask Claude to add a `sources.md` listing every summary and video it used, and to say in the `SKILL.md` that the skill was built from summaries, not the text. Future you will want to know.

Now, what you lose. You don't get the author's actual wording, and you don't get the long case studies. So this is a judgement call about what the book's value actually is:

THE BOOK'S VALUE IS IN	WORKAROUND	EXAMPLE
The process. Named steps, decision rules, a framework you run	Almost as good as the real thing	Decisive, \$100M Offers, The Challenger Sale
The wording. Annotated ads, headline swipes, verbatim examples	Buy the book. Summaries don't carry what you need	Breakthrough Advertising

Keep the shelf sharp

A book skill isn't finished when the conversion finishes. Three habits keep the shelf earning its place.

Fold your own results back in. Book-to-skill has an update mode. Point it at a file of your own notes and the existing skill name, and it merges the new material into the chapters and indexes. Every time a book skill produces a win (a landing page that converted, a proposal that closed), write a short note on what you gave it and what came back, and fold it in. The book's examples are good. Your examples are better, because they're in your market.



TEXT

```
/book-to-skill ~/Notes/offer-that-closed.md 100m-offers
```

Watch the front matter. The name and description of every skill loads into every session, so twenty book skills is fine, but twenty rambling descriptions is not. Keep each description to one paragraph of trigger phrases, and if Claude ever stops pulling a skill it used to pull, the description is the first place to look.

Buy the book when the book is the point. The workaround gets you the frameworks. It doesn't get you Schwartz's headlines. For the handful of books where the wording is the value, the copy on your shelf is the skill, and it's worth what it costs.

Drop me a comment on the video with the book you'd convert first. I read every single one.



Hey, I'm

Brad Bonanno

I build AI systems that actually run a business. These book skills are how mine writes, sells and prices.

Want the AI OS these skills live in?

Book skills are one shelf inside a founder OS. If you want the whole thing, sales, delivery, content and admin running out of one folder, book a strategy call and I'll map it with you.

cal.com/bradley-bonanno/ai-strategy-call